

LIVE

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NEWSPAPER

8th January, 2018

ITEM WISE EDITORIALS

2nd WEEK



North Korea Issue ... Positive Signs

UPSC CSE – GS II

**GS II ... EFFECT OF POLICIES AND POLITICS OF DEVELOPED
AND DEVELOPING COUNTRIES ON INDIA'S INTERESTS**



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NEWSPAPER EDITORIALS

... DISCUSSION

8th JANUARY, 2018

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Game for talks

Resumption of dialogue between the two Koreas reignites hopes of a détente

The prospect of a thaw in relations between North and South Korea, which resume talks after two years, holds out the hope of denuclearisation on the Peninsula. Lending the move diplomatic heft is the U.S.'s consent to South Korean President Moon Jae-in's proposal to delay the controversial joint military exercises between the two allies. These annual operations have traditionally caused consternation in Pyongyang. The significance of the U.S. decision can also be seen in the context of Beijing's suggestion for a freeze on joint military exercises between Washington and Seoul in exchange for a halt to Pyongyang's nuclear programme. The demand acquired added impetus ever since Seoul launched the U.S.-backed Terminal High Altitude Area Defence (THAAD) system, raising fears that its radars could snoop on Chinese security infrastructure. But the idea never received serious consideration from the U.S., as forcing Kim Jong-un, the North Korean autocrat, to completely give up the programme was the singular focus of President Donald Trump's approach. As for Mr. Kim, he sees recognition of his country as a nuclear power as a vantage point from where he could negotiate a roll-back of crippling international sanctions and a possible reconciliation with Washington.

The immediate trigger for the revival of dialogue is the Winter Olympics in PyeongChang in South Korea next month. North Korea's latest ballistic missile launches and nuclear explosions have raised global alarm over the region's safety for travel and tourism, not to mention security during the Games. Memories of the downing by North Korea of a civilian aircraft ahead of the 1988 Seoul Olympics have prompted understandable caution by the host nation. Seoul has apparently determined that the most effective means of allaying those apprehensions is to confirm the participation of North Korean athletes. The deferment of the joint military exercises with the U.S. lends further credibility to Mr. Moon's overtures to the North, as much as it assuages Chinese concerns. Beijing had imposed an unofficial blockade on South Korean trade, tourism and entertainment following the THAAD missile installation last year. But it was quick to appreciate the needless economic and diplomatic cost of that approach, even if it did not alter its stance on the missile programme. Cumulatively, these developments should boost public patronage in the entire region for the Winter Olympics. Mr. Moon, a former human rights lawyer, has been a staunch advocate of a negotiated resolution of the North Korean nuclear stand-off. A votary of reunification on the Peninsula, he may be expected to seize the momentum generated by these events to foster cooperation with the North. There will no doubt be many obstacles on that ambitious path. But a détente between neighbours is a possibility few leaders can ignore.

2 Game for talks

THE HINDU
INDIA'S NATIONAL NEWSPAPER SINCE 1878

Date :6th January, 2018

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MONGOLIA

NORTH KOREA

SOUTH KOREA

CHINA

Yellow Sea

Sea of Japan

North Pacific Ocean

JAPAN

East China Sea





NEWS REPORT

- The two Koreas decided to resume a dialogue after two years.
- It gives the hope of denuclearisation of peninsula.
- US consent to South Korean President, Moon Jae-in's proposal to delay the controversial joint military exercises between the two allies is worth noting.
- The significance of US decision can also be seen in the context of suggestion by China for a freeze on joint military exercises between Washington and Seoul.

IMPORTANT ASPECTS WHICH ARE FURTHER PRECIPITATING THE CRISIS

POINT NO: 1

TERMINAL HIGH ALTITUDE AREA DEFENCE (THAAD)



- Last year, South Korea launched US-backed THAAD system.
- This raised fears that its radars could snoop on Chinese security infrastructure.
- China was sceptical from the beginning with regard to the introduction of THAAD.
- Beijing imposed an unofficial blockade on trade, tourism and entertainment on South Korea following the THAAD missile installation.

This may be one of the reasons, why China is not pressurising North Korea to halt the nuclear programme.

IMPORTANT ASPECTS WHICH ARE FURTHER PRECIPITATING THE CRISIS

POINT NO: 2

JOINT MILITARY EXERCISES BETWEEN USA & SOUTH KOREA



- The joint military exercises between USA & South Korea are being done on quite a bigger scale and that created some sort of apprehensions, not only in North Korea but also in China.
- This is the major area of concern for both North Korea and China.

IMPORTANT ASPECTS WHICH ARE FURTHER PRECIPITATING THE CRISIS

POINT NO: 3

NUCLEAR CAPABILITY



Saddam Hussein
Former President, Iraq



Muammar Gaddafi
Former Prime Minister, Libya

- Kim sees the nuclear capability will act as a deterrence for other countries.
- He does not want to become another Saddam Hussein or Muammar Gaddafi.
- The recognition of the country as a 'nuclear power' gives the country the negotiating power for a roll back of crippling international sanctions and possible reconciliation with USA.

WHAT ARE THE CHANGED CIRCUMSTANCES?



Moon Jae-in,
President, South Korea



- 1** Winter Olympics are going to be held in Pyeongchang in South Korea next month and South Korea wants North Korea to participate in it.
- 2** The South Korean President, Moon Jae-in himself was a former Human Rights Lawyer. He has been a staunch advocate of a negotiated solution of the North Korean nuclear stand-off. He is a votary of reunification of the peninsula.

Probably, South Korea may influence more North Korea than any third country like China or America.

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